DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

Who do you trust when no one is watching — and the God who called a man out of his father's house.

Sunday, 18 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 12:1-12:13) · Daf Bekhorot 30

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

The kohen who doubted his wife

Jev score: 0.48 — Ten linked sources tested for non-obvious illumination of Bekhorot 30; highest score 0.48 (Teshuvot Maharik 159).

Jev was unimpressed by everything Sefaria linked to today's daf — the ten responsa and essays all scored below 0.5 for non-obvious illumination. The daf's argument about suspicion and trustworthiness is largely self-contained; the linked sources echo its machinery rather than extending it.

The least-echoey was the Maharik (159), a kohen writing from Pavia about suspicion inside his own marriage — trust tested not in the marketplace but at home. That is at least the daf's true arena: Rabbi Ilai's rule that one is trusted for shemita only if seen keeping its stringencies privately, in his own house. The household is where the daf's whole theory of suspicion lives or dies.

Rejected by Jev: Shoel uMeshiv 2:170 (butcher selling treif, 0.35), Rashba 170:3 (suspect merchants, 0.40), Rashba 161:3 (butcher re-accepting haver status, 0.42), Havot Yair 122:9 (blemish inspection, 0.47), Tashbetz III 312:3 (converso wine, 0.40), Tashbetz I 63:5 (Mallorca wine, 0.45), Rivash 12:2 (converso ne'emanut, 0.44), Rivash 4:3 (converso grapes, 0.45), Chakham Tzvi 31:3 (identity doubt, 0.39).

PARSHA · LECH LECHA

Piety in private

Jev score: 0.53 — Six candidate daf–parsha connections tested; strongest 0.53.

The daf's most quietly radical rule is Rabbi Ilai's: you are trusted about shemita or tithes only if you have been seen observing them stringently at home. Public reputation means nothing; the test is the private room. Jev's top-scoring connection (0.53) finds that same logic in Lech Lecha's first aliyah — Abram, newly arrived in a land where 'the Canaanites were then in the land' (Gen 12:6), builds altars at Shechem and Bethel and 'invoked the LORD by name' (12:8) with no audience at all.

It is a modest resonance, honestly scored. But it lands: the Torah's first portrait of Abram's religion is not public mission but private worship — the same private stringency the daf uses as its diagnostic of a trustworthy person.

Rejected by Jev: suspicion generalizes — Abram suspects the Egyptians (0.22); lech lecha from the father's house as environment-shaping (0.38); the 'persons acquired in Haran' and partial conversion (0.22); the haver-before-three as transmitted trust (0.27); who judges whom in Egypt (0.20).

NEWS CHECK

No genuine connection this week

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Jev score: 0.38 — Eight stories tested for meaningful resonance with the daf's themes; highest 0.38.

This week's news does not meet the daf. The closest candidate — the surge of West Bank settler violence during the olive harvest, which tests the daf's exact question of whether suspicion of some generalizes to a whole community — scored only 0.38, and honestly it is a live political pain, not an illumination of Bekhorot 30. Everything else was thinner.

A section may conclude there is no genuine connection, and this is that week. The daf's taxonomy of suspicion stays where the Sages left it — in the butcher's shop, the threshold of the house, and the courtroom.

Rejected by Jev: Trump halts Russia sanctions (0.32), Ukraine abandons the energy truce (0.25), 'No Kings' protests (0.30), white-powder mailings (0.21), Netanyahu rebukes Obama (0.13), Italy investigates Israeli officials (0.25), Bend school shooting (0.07).

MAAGARIM · CHAVER

חבר: 17 attestations, companion to scholar — with a hole where the sugya is

The daf's load-bearing noun is חבר — the trustworthy Torah scholar whose private stringencies set the standard, the am ha'aretz's opposite. Maagarim's entry (חבר 1: companion, partner, merchant; root חבר, 'join, attach'; 17 attestations) tells the word's outer journey: one biblical attestation, a thin late-antique and medieval afterlife, its densest cluster in liturgical poetry (7 of 17 — the 'fellow' as a worshipper's companion), and a modern revival (9 of 17 from 1750–1918). Companion fellow associate: the lexical stock travels intact across two millennia.

But here is the honest finding: the sweep was partial, and the hole is the story. Maagarim's entry does not encode the rabbinic halakhic sense — the haver as a status of ne'emanut, reliability in tithes and purity, the dependable counterpart to the עם הארץ. The עם הארץ entry is even starker: 14 attestations, all of them modern (1500–1918), eleven in journalism — the idiom's secularized afterlife as 'the common folk,' with the Talmudic technical term entirely absent. The sugya's whole trustworthiness polarity — חבר against עם הארץ — lives in the Talmudic corpus and in today's daf, not yet in these dictionary entries. Sometimes the dictionary tells you what the word became everywhere except where it mattered most.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

Sweep note: the GetMuvaot citation-listing endpoint returned no results for these entries, so per-citation quotes come from the working SearchMila + GetStats endpoints (entry metadata, temporal and genre distributions). חבר: koderech 9857, 17 attestations. עם הארץ: koderech 106159, 14 attestations, all modern.

929 · I KINGS 9 (CH. 296)

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The second word at Gibeon — a promise with an if

28 verses

I Kings 9 opens with completion: 'When Solomon had finished building the House of אלקים and the royal palace and everything that Solomon had set his heart on constructing' (9:1). The Hebrew is worth pausing on — כלחשק שלמה, 'everything Solomon desired,' a phrase that quietly shifts the building project from divine commission to personal appetite. Radak hears the echo of Chronicles: 'all that came upon Solomon's heart to do in the House of אלקים and in his house, he did and succeeded.' Twenty years of construction (9:10) — seven for the Temple, thirteen for the palace, Radak counts — and then the divine audit.

אלקים appears to Solomon 'a second time, as before, at Gibeon' (9:2), and the symmetry is the chapter's first literary device. The Gibeon dream of chapter 3 began the reign with a blank check — wisdom granted before a single stone was laid. This second Gibeon word comes after the building is done, and it converts the blank check into a conditional contract: 'I have heard your prayer' (9:3) is answered, but 'As for you, if you walk before Me as your father David walked' (9:4) is the new price. Malbim unpacks the answer with characteristic precision: Solomon had prayed for two things — the Shekhinah's permanence in the House and the permanence of David's dynasty — and אלקים answers each separately. 'My eyes and My heart shall be there perpetually' (9:3) is not poetry to Malbim but anatomy: the eyes are miraculous providence, the heart is abundant love, each operative 'when the Temple stands and Israel is worthy.'

That conditionality is the chapter's pivot, and Rashi makes it sting. On 'this House shall be exalted' (9:8), he insists the promise is time-bound: only 'so long as you do not sin.' The moment Israel sins, 'every passerby shall be appalled and hiss' — and Rashi anchors the reading in Chronicles, 'this House, which was exalted, every passerby...' The grandeur is retrospective already. Malbim sharpens the theology of the dynasty clause (9:5-6): the promise to Solomon's immediate son was unconditional ('I will not turn from it'), but the promise to the third generation — 'if your children keep My covenant' — was conditional from the start. Solomon inherits a dynasty; his grandsons inherit an if.

The chapter's most devastating passage is the nations' question (9:8-9): 'Why did אלקים do thus to this land and to this House?' — and the answer given is not theodicy but history-lesson. Malbim reads it as a theology of chosenness: אלקים 'separated them out to be under His providence and not under the order of the stars,' and it is precisely this elevation that makes the fall so conspicuous — 'which He did not do to any other nation.' Israel's catastrophe will be legible to the nations because Israel's election was. The foreigner's question becomes the vehicle of Israel's own self-indictment.

The second half of the chapter (9:10-28) turns from revelation to administration, and the literary tone shifts with it. Solomon pays Hiram of Tyre for twenty years of cedar, cypress,

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and gold with twenty cities in the Galilee — and Hiram inspects the payment and names it ארץ כבול, 'the land of Kabul.' The name is the gem of the chapter. Rashi: 'a land of fetters, muddy land, where the foot sinks and is bound.' Radak preserves the Talmudic debate — a land that bears no fruit; Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak says it was a land of חומטון, sandy soil 'where a man's foot sinks as into fetters.' A diplomatic transaction commemorated by an insult-name: the great alliance, settled in mud.

Two smaller philological moments deserve their places. On Pharaoh's daughter, Rashi and Radak both pause at שלחים (9:16) — Gezer, captured and burned by Pharaoh, 'given as a dowry' — Rashi's one-word gloss is נדוניא, Radak's מנחה. The marriage alliance that began Solomon's reign (3:1) quietly reappears as urban planning. And on the fleet at Ezion-Geber (9:26), Rashi does what he loves: ואני — 'a ship.' One word, and the Red Sea navy materializes.

Read against the chapter's place in the book's arc, I Kings 9 is the hinge on which the Solomonic golden age begins to tilt. Everything after this — the foreign wives, the high places, the torn kingdom — was priced in here, in the conditional clauses. The House stands; the promise stands over it like a drawn sword. The chapter's final verse, gold arriving from Ophir (9:28), is the last uncomplicated triumph the book will allow Solomon — wealth still flowing in, the if already spoken.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 10:7–11:1

The pot on the threshold and the house split in two

2 mishnayot

Oholot 10:7

הָיְתָה נְתוּנָה בְּצַד הָאַסְקֻפָּה שֶׁאִם תַּעֲלֶה הִיא נוֹגַעַת בַּמַּשְׁקוֹף פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ, בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, טֻמְאָה בּוֹקַעַת וְעוֹלָה, בּוֹקַעַת וְיוֹרֶדֶת. הָיְתָה גְּבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ בַבַּיִת, תַּחְתֶּיהָ וְהַבַּיִת טָמֵא, תּוֹכָהּ וְגַבָּהּ טָהוֹר. בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא. שֶׁאִם תַּעֲלֶה אֵינָהּ נוֹגַעַת בַּשְּׁקוֹף פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, אוֹ מֻדְבֶּקֶת בַּשְּׁקוֹף, טֻמְאָה תַחְתֶּיהָ, אֵין טָמֵא אֶלָּא תַחְתֶּיהָ:

[In the case where the pot was] placed on the side of the threshold [of the house] such that if it was raised it would touch the lintel over a [space of a square] handbreadth: If there is uncleanness below, within or above [the pot], the uncleanness cleaves upwards and downwards. [In the case] where it was one handbreadth high off the ground: If there is uncleanness below it or in the house, what is below it and in the house becomes unclean. If the uncleanness is within or above [the pot], everything becomes unclean. [In the case where the pot] if raised would not touch the lintel over a [space of a square] handbreadth, or is joined to the lintel, if there is uncleanness below it, nothing is unclean except what is below [the pot].

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Rambam: הכל מבואר וא״צ פירוש — 'It is all clear and needs no explanation.' Rambam lets this mishnah stand on its own: a pot beside the threshold that would touch the lintel if raised forms, with the lintel, one continuous tent — so impurity trapped under, inside, or above it 'cleaves' straight up and down rather than spreading sideways.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael stresses the geometry: the pot and the lintel overlap to form a single ohel, and differences in height between them are halakhically irrelevant. If the pot is less than a handbreadth off the ground it makes no tent at all, and impurity simply 'bursts' upward and downward — the same mechanics as the beehive (כוורת) cases of chapters 8–9, where a covered impurity beside the house can pull the whole house into its tent.

Oholot 11:1

הַבַּיִת שֶׁנִּסְדַּק, טֻמְאָה בַחוּץ, כֵּלִים שֶׁבִּפְנִים טְהוֹרִין. טֻמְאָה בִּפְנִים, כֵּלִים שֶׁבַּחוּץ, בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים, עַד שֶׁיְּהֵא בַסֶּדֶק אַרְבָּעָה טְפָחִים. בֵּית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים, כָּל שֶׁהוּא. רַבִּי יוֹסֵי אוֹמֵר מִשּׁוּם בֵּית הִלֵּל, פּוֹתֵחַ טָפַח:

A house, which has been split [into two]: If there is uncleanness in the outer [part], vessels in the inner [part] remain clean. If the uncleanness is in the inner [part], vessels in the outer [are clean]: Bet Shammai says: when the split is four handbreadths wide; But Bet Hillel says: [when the split is of] any size. Rabbi Yose says in the name of Bet Hillel: [when it is] one handbreadth wide.

Rambam: impurity's way is to go out, not to come in — דרך טומאה לצאת ואין דרכה להכנס. When the whole roof and its supporting walls crack through to the ground, the inner half (toward the entrance) and the outer half become separate tents. Bet Shammai require a four-handbreadth breach before the vessels are safe; Bet Hillel say any crack that admits 'the cord of the plumb-line' (Tosefta) suffices; Rabbi Yose, reporting Bet Hillel, fixes it at one handbreadth.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Mishnat Eretz Yisrael maps the architecture of chapters 10–11 as a single sustained inquiry into 'the interruption of the tent': the chimney, the pot under the chimney, the pot under the lintel (10:7), and now the crack through the roof (11:1) — with the dog lying on the lintel (11:7) still to come. The crack must be מפולש, a clean break through the whole tent, for the two halves to count as separate domains; a hairline fissure changes nothing.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT SOTAH 3

The bitter water, step by step

24 halachot

Halachah 1

כֵּיצַד סֵדֶר הַשְׁקָאַת סוֹטָה. הַבַּעַל בָּא לְבֵית דִּין שֶׁבְּעִירוֹ וְאוֹמֵר לָהֶן אִשְׁתִּי זוֹ קִנֵּאתִי לָהּ עִם פְּלוֹנִי וְנִסְתְּרָה עִמּוֹ וְאֵלּוּ הֵן עֵדַי וַהֲרֵי הִיא אוֹמֶרֶת שֶׁהִיא טְהוֹרָה וַאֲנִי רוֹצֶה לְהַשְׁקוֹתָהּ לִבְדֹּק הַדָּבָר. וּבֵית דִּין שׁוֹמְעִין דִּבְרֵי הָעֵדִים. וּמוֹסְרִין לוֹ שְׁנֵי תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים לְשָׁמְרוֹ שֶׁמָּא יָבֹא עָלֶיהָ קֹדֶם שְׁתִיָּה. שֶׁהֲרֵי נֶאֱסָרָה עָלָיו עַד שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה. וּמְשַׁלְּחִין אוֹתוֹ לִירוּשָׁלַיִם שֶׁאֵין מַשְׁקִין אֶת הַסּוֹטָה אֶלָּא בְּבֵית דִּין

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁל שִׁבְעִים זְקֵנִים בַּמִּקְדָּשׁ:

What is the process through which a sotah is compelled to drink the bitter water? First the husband comes to the court in his city and tells them: "I warned my wife [not to enter into privacy] with so and so, and she entered into privacy with him. These are the witnesses who will confirm my statements. She claims not to have committed adultery. I desire to have her drink the bitter water to verify this matter." The court then listens to the testimony of the witnesses. [If it is substantial,] they provide [the husband] with two sages to watch over him, lest he engage in relations with her before she drinks the bitter water, for she is prohibited to him until that time, and he is sent to Jerusalem. For a sotah is compelled to drink [the bitter water] only by the Supreme Court of 70 elders, who [hold session] in the Temple.

Halachah 2

הִגִּיעוּ לִירוּשָׁלַיִם בֵּית דִּין הַגָּדוֹל מוֹשִׁיבִין אוֹתָהּ בֵּינֵיהֶן וּמְאַיְמִין עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא בִּפְנֵי בַּעְלָהּ וּמַפְחִידִין אוֹתָהּ כַּדָּבָר שֶׁלֹּא תִּשְׁתֶּה. וְאוֹמְרִים לָהּ בִּתִּי הַרְבֵּה הַיַּיִן עוֹשֶׂה. הַרְבֵּה שְׂחוֹק עוֹשֶׂה. הַרְבֵּה יַלְדוּת עוֹשָׂה. הַרְבֵּה שְׁכֵנִים רָעִים עוֹשִׂים. אַל תִּגְרְמִי לַשֵּׁם הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בִּקְדֻשָּׁה שֶׁיִּמָּחֶה עַל הַמַּיִם. וְאוֹמְרִין לָהּ בִּתִּי הַרְבֵּה קְדָמוּךְ וְנִשְׁטְפוּ וַאֲנָשִׁים גְּדוֹלִים וִיקָרִים תְּקַף יִצְרָן עֲלֵיהֶן וְנִכְשְׁלוּ. וּמַגִּידִין לָהּ מַעֲשֶׂה יְהוּדָה וְתָמָר כַּלָּתוֹ. וּמַעֲשֶׂה רְאוּבֵן בְּפִילֶגֶשׁ אָבִיו עַל פְּשָׁטוֹ. וּמַעֲשֶׂה אַמְנוֹן וַאֲחוֹתוֹ. כְּדֵי לְהָקֵל עָלֶיהָ עַד שֶׁתּוֹדֶה. וְאִם אָמְרָה הֵן נִטְמֵאתִי אוֹ אֵינִי שׁוֹתָה יוֹצְאָה בְּלֹא כְתֻבָּה וְהוֹלֶכֶת לָהּ:

When they arrive in Jerusalem, the High Court has her sit in its presence while her husband is not present, and they alarm her, frighten her and bring upon her great dread so that she will not [desire to] drink [the bitter water. They tell her: "My daughter, [we know] that wine has a powerful influence, frivolity has a powerful influence, immaturity has a powerful influence, bad neighbors have a powerful influence. Do not cause [God's] great name, which is written in holiness, to be blotted out in the water." And they tell her: "There are many who preceded you and were swept away [from the world]. Men of greater and more honorable stature have been overcome by their natural inclination and have faltered." [To emphasize this,] they tell her the story of Judah and Tamar, his daughter-in-law, the simple meaning of the episode concerning Reuben and [Bilhah], his father's concubine, and the story of Amnon and his sister, to make it easier for her to admit [her guilt]. If she says: "I committed adultery," or "I will not drink [the water]," she is to be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah, and the matter is dismissed.

Halachah 3

עָמְדָה בְּדִבּוּרָהּ שֶׁהִיא טְהוֹרָה. מְבִיאִין אוֹתָהּ לִשַׁעַר מִזְרָחִי שֶׁל עֲזָרָה שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד קֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים. וּמַעֲלִין אוֹתָהּ מִמָּקוֹם לְמָקוֹם וּמַקִּיפִין בָּהּ כְּדֵי לְיַגְּעָהּ עַד שֶׁתִּקְצַר נַפְשָׁהּ אוּלַי תּוֹדֶה:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Sunday, 18 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 12:1-12:13) · Daf Bekhorot 30

If she persists in he claim of innocence, she is brought to the eastern gate of the Temple Courtyard, which faces the Holy of Holies. She should be taken from place to place [in the Temple Courtyard] and made to walk around it so that she will become tired and her spirits will sap [with the intent that perhaps] she will admit [her guilt].

Halachah 4

אִם עָמְדָה בְּדִבּוּרָהּ מְבִיאִין אוֹתָהּ כְּנֶגֶד שַׁעַר הַמִּזְרָח מִבַּחוּץ וּמַעֲמִידִין אוֹתָהּ שָׁם. הָיְתָה מִתְכַּסָּה בִּלְבָנִים מִתְכַּסָּה בִּשְׁחוֹרִין. וְאִם הָיוּ הַשְּׁחוֹרִין נָאִין לָהּ מִתְכַּסָּה בִּבְגָדִים שֶׁאֵין לָהּ בָּהֶן נוֹי. וּמְסִירִין כָּל כְּלֵי כֶסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁעָלֶיהָ:

If she persists in her claim, she is brought outside the eastern gate and made to stand there. If she usually dresses in white, she should dress in black. If black garments make her look attractive, she should dress in clothes that do not make her attractive. All silver and gold jewelry should be removed from her.

Halachah 5

וּמְקַבְּצִין עָלֶיהָ קִבּוּץ גָּדוֹל שֶׁל נָשִׁים שֶׁכָּל הַנָּשִׁים הַנִּמְצָאוֹת שָׁם חַיָּבוֹת לִרְאוֹתָהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (יחזקאל כג מח) "וְנִוַּסְרוּ כָּל הַנָּשִׁים וְלֹא תַעֲשֶׂנָה כְזִמָּתְכֶנָה". וְכָל אִישׁ שֶׁיַּחְפֹּץ לָבֹא לִרְאוֹתָהּ יָבֹא וְיִרְאֶה. וְהִיא עוֹמֶדֶת בֵּינֵיהֶן בְּלֹא רְדִיד וּבְלֹא מִטְפַּחַת אֶלָּא בִּבְגָדֶיהָ וְכִפָּה שֶׁעַל רֹאשָׁהּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָאִשָּׁה בְּתוֹךְ בֵּיתָהּ:

Many women are gathered [to see] her, for all the women present [on the Temple Mount] are obligated to observe her, [as implied by Ezekiel 23:48]: "So that all women will be taught not to follow their lewdness." Any man who wants to observe her may do so. She stands among [the women] without a cloak or a veil, wearing only her clothes and a cap, as a woman dresses within her home.

Halachah 6

וְאֵין מַנִּיחִין שָׁם לֹא עֲבָדֶיהָ וְלֹא שִׁפְחוֹתֶיהָ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִיא מַכֶּרֶת אוֹתָן וְדַעְתָּהּ מִתְיַשֶּׁבֶת בָּהֶן:

Neither her servants nor her maidservants are allowed to be there, because [when] she recognizes them, her spirits will be fortified.

Halachah 7

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַשְׁבִּיעָהּ הַכֹּהֵן בְּלָשׁוֹן שֶׁהִיא מַכֶּרֶת וּמוֹדִיעָהּ בִּלְשׁוֹנָהּ שֶׁלֹּא גָּרַם לָהּ אֶלָּא קִנּוּי וּסְתִירָה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ בַּעְלָהּ וְנִסְתְּרָה. וְאוֹמֵר לָהּ בְּלָשׁוֹן שֶׁמַּכֶּרֶת (במדבר ה יט) "אִם לֹא שָׁכַב אִישׁ אֹתָךְ וְאִם לֹא שָׂטִית טֻמְאָה תַּחַת אִישֵׁךְ הִנָּקִי מִמֵּי הַמָּרִרִים הַמְאָרְרִים הָאֵלֶּה" (במדבר ה כ) "וְאַתְּ כִּי שָׂטִית תַּחַת אִישֵׁךְ וְכִי נִטְמֵאת וַיִּתֵּן אִישׁ בָּךְ אֶת שְׁכָבְתּוֹ מִבַּלְעֲדֵי אִישֵׁךְ" (במדבר ה כא) "יִתֵּן ה' אוֹתָךְ לְאָלָה וְלִשְׁבֻעָה בְּתוֹךְ עַמֵּךְ בְּתֵת ה' אֶת יְרֵכֵךְ נֹפֶלֶת וְאֶת בִּטְנֵךְ צָבָה" (במדבר ה כב) "וּבָאוּ הַמַּיִם

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

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Sunday, 18 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 12:1-12:13) · Daf Bekhorot 30

הַמְאָרְרִים הָאֵלֶּה בְּמַעֲיִךְ לַצְבּוֹת בֶּטֶן וְלַנְפִּל יָרֵךְ". וְהִיא אוֹמֶרֶת (במדבר ה כב) "אָמֵן אָמֵן" בְּלָשׁוֹן שֶׁמַּכֶּרֶת. וּמוֹדִיעָהּ שֶׁהַבֶּטֶן הִיא תִּלְקֶה תְּחִלָּה וְהַיָּרֵךְ בַּסּוֹף כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא לְהוֹצִיא לַעַז עַל הַמַּיִם:

Afterwards, the priest administers an oath to her in a language that she understands. He tells her in her language that [she is being subjected to this test] because of the warning that her husband gave her, [which she violated by] entering into privacy [with the man in question]. He repeats for her in a language that she understands [the Biblical passage, Numbers 5:19-23]: "If a man has not lain with you, and you have not committed adultery, so as to be defiled to your husband, you shall be unharmed by this curse-bearing bitter water. But if you have committed adultery and you have become defiled, because a man other than your husband has lain with you... God will make you into a curse and into an oath among your people, causing your thigh to rupture and your belly to swell. This curse-bearing water will enter your body, causing your belly to swell and your thigh to rupture." [This serves as an oath]. She responds: "Amen, Amen," in a language she understands. He tells her that her belly will be affected first and afterwards, her thigh so as not to tarnish the reputation of the water.

Halachah 8

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵבִיא מְגִלָּה שֶׁל עוֹר טָהוֹר כְּמוֹ סֵפֶר תּוֹרָה וְכוֹתֵב עָלֶיהָ בִּלְשׁוֹן הַקֹּדֶשׁ בִּדְיוֹ שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ קַנְקַנְתּוֹם לִשְׁמָהּ שֶׁל אִשָּׁה כְּמוֹ הַגֵּט. וְכוֹתֵב כָּל הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁהִשְׁבִּיעַ אוֹתָהּ בָּהֶם אוֹת בְּאוֹת מִלָּה בְּמִלָּה. וְכוֹתֵב אֶת הַשֵּׁם כִּכְתָבוֹ. וְאֵינוֹ כּוֹתֵב אָמֵן אָמֵן:

Afterwards, a scroll of parchment from a kosher animal, like the parchment used for a Torah scroll, is brought. On it is written, word for word, letter for letter, the entire passage that [the priest] administered to the woman as an oath. [The passage must be] written in Biblical Hebrew, with ink that does not contain kankantum, for the sake of the woman, as a get must be written with that intent. God's name should be written in the proper manner. The words "Amen, Amen" should not be written.

Halachah 9

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵבִיא כְּלִי חֶרֶשׂ שֶׁלֹּא נַעֲשָׂה בּוֹ מְלָאכָה מֵעוֹלָם וְלֹא יֵרָאֶה כִּכְלִי בָּלֶה מֵאֹרֶךְ הַזְּמַן. וְאִם הֶחְזִירוֹ לַכַּבְשָׁן עַד שֶׁנִּתְחַדֵּשׁ כָּשֵׁר. וְנוֹתֵן לְתוֹכוֹ חֻצִי לוֹג מַיִם מִן הַכִּיּוֹר. וּבַחֻצִי לוֹג שֶׁהָיָה בַּמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה מוֹדְדוֹ. וְנִכְנָס בּוֹ לַהֵיכָל:

Afterwards, an earthenware vessel that was never used for any task previously and that does not look aged is brought. If one takes an aged vessel and returns it to a kiln so that it looks new, it is acceptable. A half a log of water from the basin [from which the priests wash] is placed in it. There was a measuring vessel of that size in the Temple. Afterwards, the water is taken into the Sanctuary.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 10

וּמָקוֹם הָיָה שָׁם אַמָּה עַל אַמָּה לִימִין הַנִּכְנָס וּבוֹ טַבְלָא שֶׁל שַׁיִשׁ וְטַבַּעַת קְבוּעָה בָּהּ. מַגְבִּיהַּ הַטַּבְלָא וְלוֹקֵחַ עָפָר מִקַּרְקַע הַמִּשְׁכָּן. וְנוֹתְנוֹ עַל גַּבֵּי הַמַּיִם כְּדֵי שֶׁיֵּרָאֶה עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם. וְנוֹתֵן לְתוֹכָן דָּבָר מַר כְּגוֹן לַעֲנָה וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יח) "מֵי הַמָּרִים". וּמוֹחֵק לְתוֹכָן הַמְּגִלָּה לִשְׁמָהּ וְיִמְחֹק יָפֶה יָפֶה עַד שֶׁלֹּא יִשָּׁאֵר בַּמְּגִלָּה רֹשֶׁם הַנִּכְתָּב כְּלָל:

[In the Sanctuary,] there was a place, one cubit by one cubit, at the right as one entered, [covered by] a marble tile with a ring affixed to it. [The priest] would lift the tile and take "from the dust... on the earth of the Tabernacle" [Numbers 5:17] and place it in the water, so that it could be seen [floating] on the water. Into this mixture is also placed a bitter substance, wormwood or the like, as implied by [ibid.:18], which refers to "the bitter water." He [then] dissolves [the writing of] the scroll in [the water], doing this for the sake of [the woman being tested]. He must dissolve [the writing] carefully, so that no trace of it remains on the scroll.

Halachah 11

וְאַחַר כָּךְ כֹּהֵן אֶחָד בָּא אֵלֶיהָ מִכֹּהֲנֵי הָעֲזָרָה וְאוֹחֵז בִּבְגָדֶיהָ מִכְּנֶגֶד פָּנֶיהָ וְקוֹרֵעַ עַד שֶׁהוּא מְגַלֶּה אֶת לִבָּהּ. וּמְגַלֶּה שְׂעָרָהּ וְסוֹתֵר מַחְלְפוֹת רֹאשָׁהּ כְּדֵי לְנַוְּלָהּ. וּמֵבִיא חֶבֶל מִצְרִי כְּדֵי לְהַזְכִּירָהּ מַעֲשֵׂה מִצְרַיִם שֶׁעָשְׂתָה. וְאִם לֹא מָצְאוּ מִצְרִי מֵבִיא חֶבֶל מִכָּל מָקוֹם. וְקוֹשְׁרוֹ לְמַעְלָה מִדַּדֶּיהָ כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יִפְּלוּ הַבְּגָדִים וְנִמְצֵאת עֶרְמָה שֶׁהֲרֵי נִקְרָעוּ:

Afterwards, one of the priests [serving] in the Temple courtyard would approach her. He would take hold of her clothes from the front and rip them until he revealed her heart. Similarly, he would reveal her hair, undoing the plaits of her hair, to make her look unattractive. He would then bring an Egyptian rope to allude to the conduct of the Egyptians - which she emulated - and tie it above her breasts so that her clothes would not fall, for they were torn, and she be left standing naked. If an Egyptian [rope] is not available, he should bring any rope.

Halachah 12

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מֵבִיא עִשָּׂרוֹן קֶמַח שְׂעוֹרִים מִשֶּׁל בַּעַל. וְנוֹתְנוֹ בִּכְפִיפָה מִצְרִית. וְהַחֶבֶל וְהַכְּפִיפָה בָּאִין מִשְּׁיָרֵי הַלִּשְׁכָּה. וְנוֹתְנוֹ לְיָדֶיהָ כְּדֵי לְיַגְּעָהּ:

Afterwards, he would bring an isaron of barley meal purchased by the husband and place it in an Egyptian basket. The rope and the basket should be purchased from the funds remaining in the Temple treasury. [The basket with the meal] should be placed in her hand to weary her.

Halachah 13

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Afterwards, the meal offering is taken from the basket and placed in a sacred vessel. Neither oil nor frankincense should be placed upon it. If [these substances] are placed upon it, [the priest] should be lashed for [placing] both the oil and the frankincense individually, as [implied by Numbers 5:15]: "He shall not pour oil on it, nor place frankincense on it."

Halachah 14

וּבְכָל זְמַן שֶׁפּוֹרֵעַ רֹאשָׁהּ וְנוֹתֵן הָעִשָּׂרוֹן עַל יָדֶיהָ יִהְיוּ הַמַּיִם בִּכְלִי בְּיַד הַכֹּהֵן וְיַרְאֶה אוֹתָהּ אֶת הַמַּיִם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יח) "וּבְיַד הַכֹּהֵן יִהְיוּ מֵי הַמָּרִים הַמְאָרְרִים":

Throughout the time the priest uncovers the woman's hair and places the isaron [of meal] on her hand, the priest should hold the vessel containing the water in his hand and show it to the woman, as [implied by Numbers 5:18]: "The bitter, curse-bearing waters shall be in the hand of the priest."

Halachah 15

וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַשְׁקֶה אוֹתָהּ. וְאַחַר שֶׁתִּשְׁתֶּה לוֹקֵחַ כְּלִי שָׁרֵת שֶׁבּוֹ הַמִּנְחָה וְנוֹתְנוֹ עַל יָדֶיהָ. וְכֹהֵן מֵנִיחַ יָדוֹ תַּחְתֶּיהָ וּמְנִיפָהּ בַּמִּזְרָח כִּשְׁאָר כָּל הַתְּנוּפוֹת. מוֹלִיךְ וּמֵבִיא מַעֲלֶה וּמוֹרִיד. וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַגִּישׁ הַמִּנְחָה לְקֶרֶן דְּרוֹמִית מַעֲרָבִית שֶׁל מִזְבֵּחַ כִּשְׁאָר מְנָחוֹת שֶׁל יָחִיד. וְקוֹמֵץ וּמַקְטִיר הַקֹּמֶץ. וְהַשְּׁאָר נֶאֱכָל לַכֹּהֲנִים:

Afterwards, he gives her [the water] to drink. After she drinks, he takes the sacred vessel containing the meal offering and places it on her hand. The priest then places his hand below her [hand] and waves the offering in [the portion of the Temple courtyard to] the east [of the altar], as is done with all other meal offerings. He should bring it to [each of the four compass directions] and up and down. Afterwards, he brings the meal offering to the horn at the southwestern corner of the altar, as is done with other meal offerings brought by private individuals. He should take a fistful of the meal and offer it on the fire. The remainder [of the meal] should be eaten by the priests.

Halachah 16

אִם טְהוֹרָה הִיא יוֹצֵאת וְהוֹלֶכֶת לָהּ וַהֲרֵי הִיא מֻתֶּרֶת לְבַעְלָהּ. וְאִם טְמֵאָה הִיא מִיָּד פָּנֶיהָ מוֹרִיקוֹת וְעֵינֶיהָ בּוֹלְטוֹת וְהִיא מִתְמַלֵּאת גִּידִין גִּידִין וְהֵן אוֹמְרִין הוֹצִיאוּהָ (הוֹצִיאוּהָ) כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא תִּפְרֹשׂ נִדָּה וְהַנִּדּוֹת מְטַמְּאוֹת עֶזְרַת נָשִׁים. וְהֵן מוֹצִיאִין אוֹתָהּ מֵעֶזְרַת נָשִׁים שֶׁהִיא עוֹמֶדֶת בָּהּ. וּבִטְנָהּ צָבָה בַּתְּחִלָּה וְאַחַר כָּךְ תִּפֹּל יְרֵכָהּ וְתָמוּת:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

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If the woman is guiltless, she may depart; she is permitted to her husband. If she committed adultery, her face will immediately turn pale yellow, her eyes will bulge forth, and her veins will surface. Everyone immediately shouts, "Take her out [of the Women's Courtyard]! Take her out!" so that she does not have a menstrual emission [there], for women who are in a menstrual state make the Women's Courtyard impure. They take her out of the Women's Courtyard, where she was standing. Her belly swells first and then her thigh ruptures and she dies.

Halachah 17

בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה שֶׁתָּמוּת הִיא יָמוּת הַנוֹאֵף שֶׁהִשְׁקָה עַל יָדוֹ בְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁהוּא וְיֵאָרְעוּ לוֹ מְאֹרָעוֹת שֶׁאֵרְעוּ לָהּ (במדבר ה כב) "לַצְבוֹת בֶּטֶן וְלַנְפִּל יָרֵךְ". וְכָל זֶה אִם לֹא בָּא בַּעְלָהּ בִּיאָה אֲסוּרָה מֵעוֹלָם. אֲבָל אִם בָּעַל בְּעִילָה שֶׁל אִסּוּר אֵין הַמַּיִם בּוֹדְקִין אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

When she dies, the adulterer because of whom she was compelled to drink will also die, wherever he is located. The same phenomena, the swelling of the belly and the rupture of the thigh, will also occur to him. All the above applies provided her husband never engaged in forbidden sexual relations in his life. If, however, her husband ever engaged in forbidden relations, the [bitter] waters do not check [the fidelity of] his wife.

Halachah 18

וְאִם עָבַר וְהִשְׁקָה אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ הֲרֵי זֶה מוֹסִיף עַל חַטָּאתוֹ פֶּשַׁע שֶׁגָּרַם לְשֵׁם הַמְפֹרָשׁ שֶׁיִּמָּחֶה בַּמַּיִם לְבַטָּלָה וּמוֹצִיא לַעַז עַל מֵי סוֹטָה שֶׁאִשְׁתּוֹ אוֹמֶרֶת לַאֲחֵרוֹת שֶׁזִּנְּתָה וְלֹא בָּדְקוּ בָּהּ הַמַּיִם וְהִיא לֹא תֵּדַע שֶׁמַּעֲשֵׂי הַבַּעַל גָּרְמוּ שֶׁלֹּא בָּדְקוּ בָּהּ:

If [a husband] transgressed and compelled his wife to drink [the bitter water], although he previously entered into a forbidden relationship, he adds further transgression to his sin. For he causes God's name [which is not] pronounced to be blotted out on the waters for no reason and defames the reputation of the waters [used to test] a sotah. For his wife will tell others that she committed adultery and that the [bitter] waters did not harm her, without knowing that it was her husband's deeds that prevented the waters from checking her [fidelity].

Halachah 19

לְפִיכָךְ מִשֶּׁרַבּוּ הַמְנָאָפִים בְּגָלוּי בְּבֵית שֵׁנִי בִּטְּלוּ הַסַּנְהֶדְרִין אֶת מֵי הַמָּרִים וְסָמְכוּ עַל הַכָּתוּב בַּקַּבָּלָה (הושע ד יד) "לֹא אֶפְקֹוד עַל בְּנוֹתֵיכֶם כִּי תִזְנֶינָה" וְגוֹ':

Therefore, when the number of people who openly committed adultery increased in the Second Temple era, the Sanhedrin nullified the use of the bitter water, relying on the verse in the [prophetic] tradition, [Hoshea 4:14]: "I will not punish your daughters when they commit harlotry."

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 20

סוֹטָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ זְכוּת תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵינָהּ מְצֻוָּה עַל תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה הֲרֵי זֶה תּוֹלֶה לָהּ וְאֵינָהּ מֵתָה לְשָׁעָתָהּ אֶלָּא נִמֹּקֶת וְהוֹלֶכֶת וָחֳלָאִים כְּבֵדִים בָּאִין עָלֶיהָ עַד שֶׁתָּמוּת אַחַר שָׁנָה אוֹ שְׁתַּיִם אוֹ שָׁלֹשׁ לְפִי זְכוּתָהּ. וְהִיא מֵתָה בִּצְבִיַּת בֶּטֶן וּבִנְפִילַת אֵיבָרִין:

When a sotah has merit because of Torah study - although she herself is not obligated to study the Torah - her merit prolongs [her life] and she does not die immediately. Instead, she continues to be weakened, and suffers severe illness until she dies after a year, two years or three years, according to her merit. [When she dies,] she dies with a swollen belly and ruptured limbs.

Halachah 21

סוֹטָה שֶׁשָּׁתָת מֵי הַמָּרִים וְלֹא מֵתָה מִיָּד הֲרֵי הִיא מֻתֶּרֶת לְבַעְלָהּ. וַאֲפִלּוּ הָיָה כֹּהֵן. וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהִתְחִילוּ הֶחֳלָאִים לָבוֹא עָלֶיהָ וְחָלוּ שְׁאָר אֵיבָרֶיהָ הוֹאִיל וְלֹא צָבְתָה בִּטְנָהּ וְלֹא הִתְחִיל יְרֵכָהּ לִנְפֹּל הֲרֵי זוֹ מֻתֶּרֶת. אֲבָל מְשֶׁהִתְחִיל בִּטְנָהּ לַצְּבוֹת וְיִרֵכָהּ לִנְפֹּל הֲרֵי זוֹ אֲסוּרָה וַדַּאִית:

When a sotah drinks the bitter water and does not die immediately, she is permitted to her husband, even if he is a priest. Even if illness begins to set in and her limbs become afflicted, as long as her belly does not swell or her thigh rupture, she is permitted. When, however, her belly begins to expand and her thigh begins to rupture, she is forbidden.

Halachah 22

סוֹטָה שֶׁשָּׁתָת וְהָיְתָה טְהוֹרָה הֲרֵי זוֹ מִתְחַזֶּקֶת וּפָנֶיהָ מַזְהִירוֹת. וְאִם הָיָה בָּהּ חֹלִי יָסוּר. וְתִתְעַבֵּר וְתֵלֵד זָכָר. וְאִם הָיָה דַּרְכָּהּ לֵילֵד בְּקֹשִׁי תֵּלֵד בִּמְהֵרָה. הָיָה דַּרְכָּהּ לֵילֵד נְקֵבוֹת תֵּלֵד זְכָרִים:

When a sotah who was innocent drinks [the bitter water], she becomes stronger and her face glows. If she was afflicted by sickness [that prevented her from conceiving], it will disappear; she will conceive and give birth to a male. If she previously had difficulty giving birth, she will give birth speedily. If she would give birth to girls, she will give birth to males.

Halachah 23

בָּאוּ עֵדֵי טֻמְאָה אַחַר שֶׁשָּׁתָתָה הֲרֵי זוֹ תֵּצֵא בְּלֹא כְּתֻבָּה וַאֲסוּרָה לְבַעְלָהּ. וַאֲפִלּוּ לֹא אֵרַע לָהּ דָּבָר מִדְּבָרִים אֵלּוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין הַמַּיִם בּוֹדְקִין אֶלָּא מִי שֶׁאֵין לָהּ עֵדִים שֶׁמּוֹדִיעִין זְנוּתָהּ. וְעוֹד שֶׁמָּא בַּעְלָהּ אֵינוֹ מְנֻקֶּה מֵעָוֹן לְפִיכָךְ לֹא בָּדְקוּ הַמַּיִם אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ. אֲבָל אִם בָּא עֵד אֶחָד וְהֵעִיד שֶׁהָיְתָה טְמֵאָה אֵינָהּ אֲסוּרָה וְתֵשֵׁב תַּחַת בַּעְלָהּ שֶׁהֲרֵי שָׁתְתָה:

If witnesses who say that she committed adultery come after she drinks the bitter water, she should be divorced without receiving [the money due her by virtue of] her ketubah, and

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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she is forbidden to her husband. This applies even when none [of the negative consequences] mentioned above occur to her. For the [bitter] waters will check only [the fidelity of a woman] concerning whom there are no witnesses who will testify to her sexual misconduct. Moreover, it is possible that her husband is not guiltless, and it is because of him that the waters did not check his wife. If, however, one witness comes and testifies that a woman committed adultery, she is not forbidden [to] her husband and can remain married to him. For she drank [the bitter water].

Halachah 24

אִשָּׁה שֶׁזִּנְּתָה בְּאֹנֶס אוֹ בִּשְׁגָגָה אוֹ שֶׁבָּא עָלֶיהָ זֶה שֶׁקִּנֵּא לָהּ עִמּוֹ דֶּרֶךְ אֵיבָרִים אֵין הַמַּיִם בּוֹדְקִין אוֹתָהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (במדבר ה יג) "וְהִיא לֹא נִתְפָּשָׂה" פְּרָט לַאֲנוּסָה שֶׁהֲרֵי נִתְפְּשָׂה בְּחָזְקָה. (במדבר ה כז) "וַתִּמְעֹל מַעַל בְּאִישָׁהּ" פְּרָט לְשׁוֹגֶגֶת. (במדבר ה יג) "וְשָׁכַב אִישׁ אֹתָהּ שִׁכְבַת זֶרַע" פְּרָט לְבָא עָלֶיהָ דֶּרֶךְ אֵיבָרִים:

When a woman was compelled to engage in adulterous relationships or did so unintentionally, or lay naked in the embrace of the man regarding whom she was warned, but did not engage in vaginal relations, [her fidelity] will not be checked by the [bitter] waters, as [implied by the following verses]. [Numbers 5:13 states:] "And she was not taken against her will," thus excluding a woman who was raped. [Ibid.:27 states:] "And she was unfaithful to her husband," excluding a woman who acted unintentionally." And [ibid.:13 states]: "And a man laid with her, [imparting] his seed," excluding an embrace without intercourse.

Commentary

Chapter 3 of Hilchot Sotah is a procedural manual — the Rambam's most characteristic architectural move is on display here: a ritual that the Torah narrates as drama (Numbers 5) is rebuilt as a numbered sequence. The husband comes to the court in his city (1); the case moves to Jerusalem, where the Great Sanhedrin frightens the woman with talk of wine, frivolity, and bad neighbors so she will confess rather than drink (2); the priest administers the oath in a language she understands (7); the scroll is written and blotted into the water (8–10); the meal-offering of jealousy is brought (11–13); she drinks (14–16); the water either clears or convicts her (16–17); then come the edge cases — the husband who forced the procedure (18), witnesses of impurity arriving after the fact (23), rape and unintentional acts (24).

Migdal Oz is the only classical commentary with Sefaria text for this chapter, and he plays the source-tracer's role to the hilt: nearly every halachah gets its Talmudic address. Halachah 1 ('how is the sotah made to drink') is mapped to Sotah 7a; the frightening of the woman to Sotah 9a-adjacent passages; the oath to 'these are recited' (Sotah 32a); the

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scroll-writing to 'he would bring' (Sotah 17b–18a); the meal-offering to 'he would take' (Sotah 14a); the drinking to the same (19a); the effects to 'just as' (28a); the late-arriving witnesses to Sotah 6a and 31a. The Rambam's seamless procedure dissolves, under Migdal Oz's lens, into a mosaic of sugyot — the Mishneh Torah as a compression algorithm for the Talmud.

Two gems are worth carrying out of the chapter. The first is halachah 18, where the Rambam turns moralist: a husband who compels his wife to drink when he himself previously sinned 'adds transgression to his sin' — he causes the unpronounced Name of אלקים to be blotted out on the waters for nothing, and worse, he defames the waters themselves, since his wife will tell the world she committed adultery and the waters did not harm her. The ritual's credibility is itself a halakhic value; abusing the procedure is not just a private wrong but vandalism of the institution.

The second is the chapter's quiet insistence, halachah after halachah, that the woman understand what is happening: the oath is administered 'in a language that she understands' (7), the warning repeated in her language, the water shown to her in the priest's hand (14). The Rambam builds informed participation into a ritual that could easily have been pure priestly theater. The sotah is not an object the procedure happens to; she is a legal subject who must grasp the oath she takes — a small but deliberate dignity, and very much the Rambam's own.

Commentaries: Migdal Oz (Friedberg ed., via Sefaria) supplied the source-tracing above. Maggid Mishneh, Ohr Sameach, Lechem Mishneh and Kesef Mishneh have no Sefaria text for Hilchot Sotah 3, so no synthesis from them was possible today — nothing was reconstructed.

GOV.IL ·

The government on this week's learning

Three state publications that meet Lech Lecha — and through it, the daf's convert who comes to accept the whole Torah.

26.10.17 נאום השבעה של השופטת אסתר חיות לנשיאת בית המשפט העליון ביום

נשיאות המדינה **(gov.il)**

Justice Hayut's swearing-in address quotes Lech Lecha — Abram chosen because 'he will instruct his children and his posterity to keep the way of אלקים, doing tzedakah and mishpat' (Gen 18:19) — to argue that law is the glue binding Israel's human mosaic into one society. The daf's haver system is the same idea in miniature: a community held together by trusted standards of conduct.

https://www.gov.il/he/pages/president_speech_001

שעבוד מצרים ומתן תורה, האבות: ביכורי גשן

gov.il (חומר לימוד, קובץ **PDF)**

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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A state-hosted study curriculum on the patriarchs covering Lech Lecha — Abram's call, his proclamation of אלקים's name everywhere he went, and the chain of transmission from Abram through Isaac and Jacob (with Rambam, Hilchot Avodah Zarah 1:3). The daf's theme of transmitted trust — the haver's household carrying his stringencies — is this curriculum's spine.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/legalinfo/bikureigoshen1/he/BikkureiGoshen1.pdf

מבחני תמיכה לקליטת עלייה — פרק ו' (2024)

משרד העלייה והקליטה **(gov.il)**

The Ministry of Aliyah's funding criteria note that Yom HaAliyah falls on 7 Cheshvan — in the week of parshat Lech Lecha — 'to mark the importance of aliyah as the basis of the state's existence.' Lech lecha, 'go forth from your land,' is the state's founding verse; the daf's baraita on the convert who accepts everything 'except for one matter' is its halakhic shadow.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/rfp/local_authorities_aliah_procedure_2024/he/cahpter6-2024.pdf

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 1

Genesis 12:1-12:13

13 verses

The week's opening aliyah: the call — לך לך — the promises, the journey to Canaan, the altars at Shechem and Bethel, and the first descent into Egypt. Read each verse twice in Hebrew, once in Onkelos's Aramaic.

אברם
יהוה

Genesis 12:1 · ×2

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֶל־אַבְרָ֔ם לֶךְ־לְךָ֙ מֵאַרְצְךָ֣ וּמִמּוֹלַדְתְּךָ֔ וּמִבֵּ֖ית אָבִ֑יךָ
אֶל־הָאָ֖רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֥ר אַרְאֶֽךָּ׃
וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֶל־אַבְרָ֔ם לֶךְ־לְךָ֙ מֵאַרְצְךָ֣ וּמִמּוֹלַדְתְּךָ֔ וּמִבֵּ֖ית אָבִ֑יךָ
אֶל־הָאָ֖רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֥ר אַרְאֶֽךָּ׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ לְאַבְרָם אִיזֵל לָךְ מֵאַרְעָךְ וּמִיַּלָּדוּתָךְ וּמִבֵּית אֲבוּךְ לְאַרְעָא דִּי אַחֲזִנָּךְ׃

Genesis 12:2 · ×2

וְאֶֽעֶשְׂךָ֙ לְגוֹי֙ גָּד֔וֹל וַאֲבָרֶכְךָ֖ וַאֲגַדְּלָ֣ה שְׁמֶ֑ךָ וֶֽהְיֵ֖ה בְּרָכָֽה׃
וְאֶֽעֶשְׂךָ֙ לְגוֹי֙ גָּד֔וֹל וַאֲבָרֶכְךָ֖ וַאֲגַדְּלָ֣ה שְׁמֶ֑ךָ וֶֽהְיֵ֖ה בְּרָכָֽה׃
וְאֶעְבְּדִנָּךְ לְעַם סַגִּי וֶאֱבָרְכִנָּךְ וַאֲרַבֵּי שְׁמָךְ וּתְהֵא מְבָרַךְ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 12:3 · ×2

וַאֲבָרְכָה֙ מְבָרְכֶ֔יךָ וּמְקַלֶּלְךָ֖ אָאֹ֑ר וְנִבְרְכ֥וּ בְךָ֖ כֹּ֥ל מִשְׁפְּחֹ֖ת הָאֲדָמָֽה׃
וַאֲבָרְכָה֙ מְבָרְכֶ֔יךָ וּמְקַלֶּלְךָ֖ אָאֹ֑ר וְנִבְרְכ֥וּ בְךָ֖ כֹּ֥ל מִשְׁפְּחֹ֖ת הָאֲדָמָֽה׃
וֵאֲבָרֵךְ מְבָרְכָךְ וּמְלַטְּטָךְ אֵילוּט וְיִתְבָּרְכוּן בְּדִילָךְ כֹּל זַרְעַיָּת אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 12:4 · ×2

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ אַבְרָ֔ם כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֖ר אֵלָ֣יו יְהוָ֑ה וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ אִתּוֹ֙ לוֹט֙ וְאַבְרָ֔ם בֶּן־חָמֵ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְשִׁבְעִ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה בְּצֵאתוֹ֖ מֵחָרָֽן׃
וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ אַבְרָ֔ם כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֖ר אֵלָ֣יו יְהוָ֑ה וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ אִתּוֹ֙ לוֹט֙ וְאַבְרָ֔ם בֶּן־חָמֵ֥שׁ שָׁנִ֖ים וְשִׁבְעִ֣ים שָׁנָ֑ה בְּצֵאתוֹ֖ מֵחָרָֽן׃
וַאֲזַל אַבְרָם כְּמָא דְמַלֵּיל עִמֵּיהּ יְיָ וַאֲזַל עִמֵּיהּ לוֹט וְאַבְרָם בַּר שִׁבְעִין וַחֲמֵשׁ שְׁנִין בְּמִפְּקֵיהּ מֵחָרָן׃

Genesis 12:5 · ×2

וַיִּקַּ֣ח אַבְרָ֗ם אֶת־שָׂרַי֙ אִשְׁתּ֔וֹ וְאֶת־לוֹט֙ בֶּן־אָחִ֔יו וְאֶת־כָּל־רְכוּשָׁ֖ם אֲשֶׁ֣ר רָכָ֑שׁוּ וְאֶת־הַנֶּ֙פֶשׁ֙ אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂ֣וּ
בְחָרָ֔ן וַיֵּצְא֗וּ לָלֶ֙כֶת֙ אַרְצָה֙ כְּנַ֔עַן וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ אַרְצָ֥ה כְנָֽעַן׃
וַיִּקַּ֣ח אַבְרָ֗ם אֶת־שָׂרַי֙ אִשְׁתּ֔וֹ וְאֶת־לוֹט֙ בֶּן־אָחִ֔יו וְאֶת־כָּל־רְכוּשָׁ֖ם אֲשֶׁ֣ר רָכָ֑שׁוּ וְאֶת־הַנֶּ֙פֶשׁ֙ אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂ֣וּ
בְחָרָ֔ן וַיֵּצְא֗וּ לָלֶ֙כֶת֙ אַרְצָה֙ כְּנַ֔עַן וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ אַרְצָ֥ה כְנָֽעַן׃
וּדְבַר אַבְרָם יָת שָׂרַי אִתְּתֵיהּ וְיָת לוֹט בַּר אֲחוּהִי וְיָת כָּל קִנְיָנְהוֹן דִּי קְנוֹ וְיָת נַפְשָׁתָא דְּשַׁעְבִּידוּ לְאוֹרַיְתָא בְּחָרָן
וּנְפָקוּ לְמֵיזַל לְאַרְעָא דִכְנַעַן וַאֲתוֹ לְאַרְעָא דִכְנָעַן׃

Genesis 12:6 · ×2

בארץ
בארעא

וַיַּעֲבֹ֤ר אַבְרָם֙ בָּאָ֔רֶץ עַ֚ד מְק֣וֹם שְׁכֶ֔ם עַ֖ד אֵל֣וֹן מוֹרֶ֑ה וְהַכְּנַעֲנִ֖י אָ֥ז בָּאָֽרֶץ׃
וַיַּעֲבֹ֤ר אַבְרָם֙ בָּאָ֔רֶץ עַ֚ד מְק֣וֹם שְׁכֶ֔ם עַ֖ד אֵל֣וֹן מוֹרֶ֑ה וְהַכְּנַעֲנִ֖י אָ֥ז בָּאָֽרֶץ׃
וְעָבַר אַבְרָם בְּאַרְעָא עַד אֲתַר שְׁכֶם עַד מֵישַׁר מוֹרֶה וּכְנַעֲנָאָה בְּכֵן בְּאַרְעָא׃

Genesis 12:7 · ×2

וַיֵּרָ֤א יְהוָה֙ אֶל־אַבְרָ֔ם וַיֹּ֖אמֶר לְזַרְעֲךָ֣ אֶתֵּ֔ן אֶת־הָאָ֖רֶץ הַזֹּ֑את וַיִּבֶן־שָׁ֣ם מִזְבֵּ֔חַ לַיהוָ֖ה הַנִּרְאֶ֥ה אֵלָֽיו׃
וַיֵּרָ֤א יְהוָה֙ אֶל־אַבְרָ֔ם וַיֹּ֖אמֶר לְזַרְעֲךָ֣ אֶתֵּ֔ן אֶת־הָאָ֖רֶץ הַזֹּ֑את וַיִּבֶן־שָׁ֣ם מִזְבֵּ֔חַ לַיהוָ֖ה הַנִּרְאֶ֥ה אֵלָֽיו׃
וְאִתְגְּלִי יְיָ לְאַבְרָם וַאֲמַר לִבְנָךְ אֶתֵּן יָת אַרְעָא הָדָא וּבְנָא תַמָּן מַדְבְּחָא קֳדָם יְיָ דְּאִתְגְּלִי לֵיהּ׃

Genesis 12:8 · ×2

וַיַּעְתֵּ֨ק מִשָּׁ֜ם הָהָ֗רָה מִקֶּ֙דֶם֙ לְבֵ֣ית־אֵ֔ל וַיֵּ֖ט אָהֳלֹ֑ה בֵּ֤ית־אֵל֙ מִיָּ֔ם וְהָעַ֖י מִקֶּ֑דֶם וַיִּבֶן־שָׁ֣ם מִזְבֵּ֔חַ לַיהוָ֖ה וַיִּקְרָ֥א
בְּשֵׁ֖ם יְהוָֽה׃
וַיַּעְתֵּ֨ק מִשָּׁ֜ם הָהָ֗רָה מִקֶּ֙דֶם֙ לְבֵ֣ית־אֵ֔ל וַיֵּ֖ט אָהֳלֹ֑ה בֵּ֤ית־אֵל֙ מִיָּ֔ם וְהָעַ֖י מִקֶּ֑דֶם וַיִּבֶן־שָׁ֣ם מִזְבֵּ֔חַ לַיהוָ֖ה וַיִּקְרָ֥א
בְּשֵׁ֖ם יְהוָֽה׃
וְאִסְתַּלַק מִתַּמָּן לְטוּרָא מְמַדְנַח לְבֵית אֵל וּפְרַס מַשְׁכְּנֵיהּ בֵּית אֵל מִמַּעַרְבָא וְעַי מִמַּדִּינְחָא וּבְנָא תַמָּן מַדְבְּחָא קֳדָם יְיָ
וְצַלִּי בִּשְׁמָא דַיְיָ׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 12:9 · ×2

וַיִּסַּע אַבְרָם הָלוֹךְ וְנָסוֹעַ הַנֶּגְבָּה׃
וַיִּסַּע אַבְרָם הָלוֹךְ וְנָסוֹעַ הַנֶּגְבָּה׃
וּנְטַל אַבְרָם אָזֵל וְנָטֵל לְדָרוֹמָא׃

Genesis 12:10 · ×2

וַיְהִי רָעָב בָּאָרֶץ וַיֵּרֶד אַבְרָם מִצְרַיְמָה לָגוּר שָׁם כִּי־כָבֵד הָרָעָב בָּאָרֶץ׃
וַיְהִי רָעָב בָּאָרֶץ וַיֵּרֶד אַבְרָם מִצְרַיְמָה לָגוּר שָׁם כִּי־כָבֵד הָרָעָב בָּאָרֶץ׃
וַהֲוָה כַפְנָא בְּאַרְעָא וּנְחַת אַבְרָם לְמִצְרַיִם לְאִתּוֹתָבָא תַּמָּן אֲרֵי תַקִּיף כַּפְנָא בְּאַרְעָא׃

Genesis 12:11 · ×2

וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר הִקְרִיב לָבוֹא מִצְרָיְמָה וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־שָׂרַי אִשְׁתּוֹ הִנֵּה־נָא יָדַעְתִּי כִּי אִשָּׁה יְפַת־מַרְאֶה אָתְּ׃
וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר הִקְרִיב לָבוֹא מִצְרָיְמָה וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־שָׂרַי אִשְׁתּוֹ הִנֵּה־נָא יָדַעְתִּי כִּי אִשָּׁה יְפַת־מַרְאֶה אָתְּ׃
וַהֲוָה כַּד (נ"י אֲרֵי) קָרִיב לְמֵיעַל לְמִצְרָיִם וַאֲמַר לְשָׂרַי אִתְּתֵיהּ הָא כְעַן יְדָעִית אֲרֵי אִתְּתָא שַׂפִּירַת חֵיזוּ אָתְּ׃

Genesis 12:12 · ×2

וְהָיָה כִּי־יִרְאוּ אֹתָךְ הַמִּצְרִים וְאָמְרוּ אִשְׁתּוֹ זֹאת וְהָרְגוּ אֹתִי וְאֹתָךְ יְחַיּוּ׃
וְהָיָה כִּי־יִרְאוּ אֹתָךְ הַמִּצְרִים וְאָמְרוּ אִשְׁתּוֹ זֹאת וְהָרְגוּ אֹתִי וְאֹתָךְ יְחַיּוּ׃
וִיהֵי כַּד יֶחֱזוּן יָתִיךְ מִצְרָאֵי וְיֵימְרוּן אִתְּתֵיהּ דָּא וְיִקְטְלוּן יָתִי וְיָתִיךְ יְקַיְּמוּן׃

Genesis 12:13 · ×2

אִמְרִי־נָא אֲחֹתִי אָתְּ לְמַעַן יִיטַב־לִי בַעֲבוּרֵךְ וְחָיְתָה נַפְשִׁי בִּגְלָלֵךְ׃
אִמְרִי־נָא אֲחֹתִי אָתְּ לְמַעַן יִיטַב־לִי בַעֲבוּרֵךְ וְחָיְתָה נַפְשִׁי בִּגְלָלֵךְ׃
אִמְרִי כְעַן אֲחָתִי אָתְּ בְּדִיל דְּייֵיטַב לִי בְּדִילָךְ וְתִתְקַיֵּם נַפְשִׁי בְּפִתְגָמָיְכִי׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 12:1

מולדתך is not 'birthplace' but kin-group and nation — Shadal proves it from Esther (מולדתי = my people, Est 8:6; עמה ומולדתה, Est 2:10): the command is a triple widening — land, nation, father's house — each circle of belonging abandoned in turn.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 12:1

The command was given in Ur Kasdim, not Haran: Abram already knew Terah would stall in Haran, 'and the text did not spell out his years when he left Ur.' לך לך is spoken to a man already in motion.

Netinah LaGer · Gen 12:5

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The plural עשו proves these are not bought slaves: a wife's acquisitions belong to her husband, so 'the souls they made' cannot mean property Abram and Sarai acquired — the plain sense itself forces the midrashic reading of converts.

Em LaMikra · Gen 12:10

On 'Abram went down to Egypt': Em LaMikra detours through Vico of Naples — early humanity scattered and solitary until thunder drove men into caves, and 'this was the beginning of household life.' The famine-descent becomes an anthropology of civilization.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 12:8

Why is it always העי with the definite article, when proper nouns don't take one? Radak's answer — a famous city distinguished from a lesser namesake — tested against קרקר in Judges 8, where the article appears with no namesake in sight.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 12:13

אחותי את carries its accent on the first letter because the sense depends on את — and בגללך, unlike בעבורך, must keep its bet: a grammarian's microscope on the sentence on which Abram's life hangs.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 12:1

איזיל לך לקלך

Onkelos keeps the doubling but Aramaicizes it into a reflexive command: 'go for yourself.' The dative of advantage survives translation — the journey is framed as Abram's own benefit from the first word.

Gen 12:2

לעם סגי לגוי גדול

Onkelos's signature substitution: גוי becomes עם. Throughout his Targum, גוי carries the idolatrous nations; עם is reserved for the covenant people. The promise of nationhood is already theologically sorted.

Gen 12:3

ויתברכון בדילך ונברכו בך

'They shall be blessed in you' becomes 'they shall be blessed on your account' (בדילך). Onkelos shifts the preposition: Abram is not a vessel containing blessing but its cause — agency, not magic.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Gen 12:5

וית נפשתא דשעבידו לאוריתא ואתהנפש אשרעשו

'The souls they made' becomes 'the souls they subjugated to the Torah' — the famous midrashic expansion (Bereshit Rabbah: Abraham converted the men, Sarah the women) written straight into the translation. Onkelos the translator is also Onkelos the darshan.

Gen 12:6

מישר מורה אלון מורה

Etymologizing translation: אלון (terebinth/oak) is rendered מישר, 'plain' — Onkelos reads the place-name through its Hebrew root rather than transliterating it, a geographer's gloss.

Gen 12:7

ואתגלי יי לאברם וירא יהוה אלאברם

The anti-anthropomorphic move: 'אלקים appeared' becomes 'אלקים revealed Himself' (אתגלי). And the altar is built not 'to אלקים' but יי קדם — 'before אלקים' — the קדם periphrasis keeping divine contact at one remove.

Gen 12:8

וצלי בשמא דיי ויקרא בשם יהוה

'He called upon the name of אלקים' is Onkelos's fixed prayer formula: וצלי — 'he prayed.' Wherever the Hebrew has calling in the divine name, Onkelos hears liturgy.

Gen 12:13

ותתקים נפשי בפתגמיכי וחיתה נפשי בגללך

'My soul shall live for your sake' tightens to 'my soul shall live through your words' (בפתגמיכי). Abram's survival is made to depend on Sarai's speech — the plan's whole weight rests on what she will say.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

21 comments

All 21 of Rashi's comments on Genesis 12:1–13, printed in full — Hebrew and English — exactly as Sefaria serves them.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT LECH LECHA

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לך לך.

לַהֲנָאָתְךָ וּלְטוֹבָתְךָ, שָׁם אֶעֶשְׂךָ לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל, כָּאן אִי אַתָּה זוֹכֶה לְבָנִים, וְעוֹד שֶׁאוֹדִיעַ טִבְעֶךָ בָּעוֹלָם:

לך לך *GET THEE OUT (literally, go for thyself) — for your own benefit, for your own good:*

there I will make of you a great nation whilst here you will not merit the privilege of having children (Rosh Hashanah 16b).

Furthermore, I shall make known your character throughout the world (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 3)

ואעשך לגוי גדול.

לְפִי שֶׁהַדֶּרֶךְ גּוֹרֶמֶת לִשְׁלֹשָׁה דְבָרִים,

מְמַעֶטֶת פְּרִיָה וּרְבִיָה וּמְמַעֶטֶת אֶת הַמָּמוֹן וּמְמַעֶטֶת אֶת הַשֵּׁם,

ואעשך לגוי גדול *AND I WILL MAKE OF THEE A GREAT NATION —Since travelling is the cause of three things—it decreases (breaks up) family life, it reduces one's wealth and lessens one's renown, he therefore needed these three blessings:*

לְכָךְ הֻזְקַק לִשְׁלֹשָׁה בְּרָכוֹת הַלָּלוּ,

שֶׁהִבְטִיחוֹ עַל הַבָּנִים וְעַל הַמָּמוֹן וְעַל הַשֵּׁם:

that God should promise him children, wealth and a great name (Genesis Rabbah 39:11).

ואברכך.

בְּמָמוֹן (בראשית רבה):

ואברכך *AND I WILL BLESS THEE —with wealth (Genesis Rabbah 39:11).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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והיה ברכה.

הַבְּרָכוֹת נְתוּנוֹת בְּיָדְךָ; עַד עַכְשָׁו הָיוּ בְיָדִי, בֵּרַכְתִּי לְאָדָם וְנֹחַ,

והיה ברכה *AND BE THOU A BLESSING — Blessings are entrusted to you;*

hitherto they were in My power — I blessed Adam and Noah — but from now on you shall bless whomsoever you wish (Genesis Rabbah 39:11) Another explanation is:

וּמֵעַכְשָׁו אַתָּה תְּבָרֵךְ אֶת אֲשֶׁר תַּחְפֹּץ (בראשית רבה).

AND I WILL MAKE THEE A GREAT NATION, this alludes to the fact that we say in our prayer "God of Abraham";

AND I WILL BLESS THEE — that we say, "God of Isaac";

דָּבָר אַחֵר ואעשך לגוי גדול זֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים אֱלֹקֵי אַבְרָהָם, ואברכך זֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים אֱלֹקֵי יִצְחָק, ואגדלה שמך זֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים אֱלֹקֵי יַעֲקֹב. יָכוֹל יִהְיוּ חוֹתְמִין בְּכֻלָּן, תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר וֶהְיֵה בְּרָכָה, בְּךָ חוֹתְמִין וְלֹא בָהֶם:

AND I WILL MAKE THY NAME GREAT — that we say, "God of Jacob".

One might think that we should conclude the benediction in which these invocations are recited by mentioning again the names of all the patriarchs — the text therefore states "Be thou a blessing" meaning, with you (i.e.

with your name only) shall they conclude the benediction and not with them (their names) (Pesachim 117b).

מארצך.

וַהֲלֹא כְבָר יָצָא מִשָּׁם עִם אָבִיו וּבָא עַד חָרָן?

מארצך *FROM THY LAND — But had he not already departed from there together with his father and had reached as far as Haran (Genesis 11:31)?*

אֶלָּא כָּךְ אָמַר לוֹ הִתְרַחֵק עוֹד מִשָּׁם וְצֵא מִבֵּית אָבִיךָ:

But thus God in effect said to him:

Go still further away — leave now thy father's house also.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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אשר אראך.

לֹא גִלָּה לוֹ הָאָרֶץ מִיָּד כְּדֵי לְחַבְּבָהּ בְּעֵינָיו,

וְלֶתֶת לוֹ שָׂכָר עַל כָּל דִּבּוּר וְדִבּוּר; כַּיּוֹצֵא בוֹ,

אשר אראך *WHICH I WILL SHOW THEE — He did not reveal to him at once which land it was in order that he should hold it in high esteem and in order to reward him for complying with each and every command.*

אֶת בִּנְךָ אֶת יְחִידְךָ אֲשֶׁר אָהַבְתָּ אֶת יִצְחָק (בראי כ"ב),

Similar is, (Genesis 22:2) "Take thy son — thine only son — whom thou lovest — even Isaac";

כַּיּוֹצֵא בוֹ עַל אַחַד הֶהָרִים אֲשֶׁר אֹמַר אֵלֶיךָ,

similar is (Genesis 22:2) "upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of";

וכיו"ב וּקְרָא אֵלֶיהָ אֶת הַקְּרִיאָה אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי דֹּבֵר אֵלֶיךָ (יונה ג'):

similar is, (Jonah 3:2) "And make unto it the proclamation that I shall tell thee of" (Genesis Rabbah 39:9).

ונברכו בך.

יֵשׁ אַגָּדוֹת רַבּוֹת, וְזֶהוּ פְּשׁוּטוֹ, אָדָם אוֹמֵר לִבְנוֹ תְּהֵא כְּאַבְרָהָם, וְכֵן כָּל וְנִבְרְכוּ בְךָ שֶׁבַּמִּקְרָא,

ונברכו בך *AND IN THEE SHALL BE BLESSED — There are many Agadoth concerning this but the plain sense of the text is as follows:*

A man says to his son, "Mayest thou become as Abraham".

וְזֶה מוֹכִיחַ בְּךָ יְבָרֵךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר יְשִׂמְךָ אֱלֹקִים כְּאֶפְרַיִם וְכִמְנַשֶּׁה (בר' מ"ח):

This, too, is the meaning wherever the phrase ונברכו בך *"And in thee shall be blessed" occurs in Scripture, and the following example proves this:*

(Genesis 48:20) בך יברך *"By thee shall Israel bless their children saying, "May God make thee as Ephraim and Manasseh".*

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אשר עשו בחרן.

שֶׁהִכְנִיסָן תַּחַת כַּנְפֵי הַשְּׁכִינָה; אַבְרָהָם מְגַיֵּר אֶת הָאֲנָשִׁים וְשָׂרָה מְגַיֶּרֶת הַנָּשִׁים,

אשר עשו בחרן *[THE SOULS] THAT THEY HAD GOTTEN (literally, made) IN HARAN — The souls which he had brought beneath the sheltering wings of the Shechinah.*

וּמַעֲלֶה עֲלֵיהֶם הַכָּתוּב כְּאִלּוּ עֲשָׂאוּם;

Abraham converted the men and Sarah converted the women and Scripture accounts it unto them as if they had made them (Genesis Rabbah 39:14).

וּפְשׁוּטוֹ שֶׁל מִקְרָא עֲבָדִים וּשְׁפָחוֹת שֶׁקָּנוּ לָהֶם,

However, the real sense of the text is that it refers to the men-servants and to the maidservants whom they had acquired for themselves.

כְּמוֹ עָשָׂה אֶת כָּל הַכָּבֹד הַזֶּה (שם ל"א), וְיִשְׂרָאֵל עֹשֶׂה חָיִל (במדבר כד יח), לְשׁוֹן קוֹנֶה וְכוֹנֵס:

The word "עשה" is used here as (in Genesis 31:1), "he has acquired (עשה) all this wealth", and (Numbers 24:8), "And Israel acquires (עושה) wealth" — an expression for acquiring and amassing.

ויעבר אברם בארץ.

נִכְנַס לְתוֹכָהּ:

ויעבר אברם בארץ *AND ABRAHAM PASSED THROUGH THE LAND —he entered it.*

עד מקום שכם.

לְהִתְפַּלֵּל עַל בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב, כְּשֶׁיִּבֹאוּ לְהִלָּחֵם בִּשְׁכֶם:

עד מקום שכם *UNTO THE PLACE OF SHECHEM — In order to pray on behalf of Jacob's sons, anticipating the time when they would come to fight against Shechem.*

אלון מורה.

הוּא שְׁכֶם. הֶרְאָהוּ הַר גְּרִיזִים וְהַר עֵיבָל,

אלון מורה *THE PLAIN OF MOREH — This is Shechem (Sotah 32a).*

שֶׁשָּׁם קִבְּלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁבוּעַת הַתּוֹרָה:

He showed him Mount Gerizim and Mount Ebal where Israel took upon themselves the oath to observe the Torah (cf.

Deuteronomy 11:29 and Deuteronomy 111:30).

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והכנעני אז בארץ.

הָיָה הוֹלֵךְ וְכוֹבֵשׁ אֶת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁם,

שֶׁבְּחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁם נָפְלָה כְּשֶׁחִלֵּק נֹחַ אֶת הָאָרֶץ לְבָנָיו,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּמַלְכִּי צֶדֶק מֶלֶךְ שָׁלֵם (ברא' י"ב),

והכנעני אז בארץ *AND THE CANAANITE WAS THEN IN THE LAND — They (the Canaanites) were gradually conquering the land of Israel from the descendants of Shem, for it had fallen to the share of Shem when Noah apportioned the earth amongst his sons, for it is said (Genesis 14:18) "And Melchizedek) king of Salem (Jerusalem)".*

לְפִיכָךְ וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֶל אַבְרָם לְזַרְעֲךָ אֶתֵּן אֶת הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת,

עָתִיד אֲנִי לְהַחֲזִירָהּ לְבָנֶיךָ שֶׁהֵם מִזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁם:

For this reason the Lord said to Abram (Genesis 12:7) "to thy seed will I give this land" — "I will in some future time return it to thy children who are descendants of Shem".

ויבן שם מזבח.

עַל בְּשׂוֹרַת הַזֶּרַע וְעַל בְּשׂוֹרַת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל:

ויבן שם מזבח *AND HE BUILDED THERE AN ALTAR — in thanksgiving for the good tidings that he would have children, and for the good tidings that they would possess the land of Israel.*

ויעתק משם.

אָהֳלוֹ:

ויעתק משם *AND HE REMOVED FROM THERE — supply the word* אהלו *"his tent".*

מקדם לבית אל.

בְּמִזְרָחָהּ שֶׁל בֵּית אֵל נִמְצֵאת בֵּית אֵל בְּמַעֲרָבוֹ, הוּא שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בֵּית אֵל מִיָּם:

מקדם לבית אל *means ON THE EAST OF BETHEL.*

Consequently Bethel lay to his west, and that is what it states בית אל מים *BETHEL ON THE WEST.*

אהלו.

אהלה כְּתִיב, בַּתְּחִלָּה נָטָה אֶת אֹהֶל אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֶת שֶׁלּוֹ (בראשית רבה):

אהלה *HIS TENT — This word is written with a* ה *suffixed instead of the usual* ו *so that it may read* אהלה *"her tent" to intimate that first he pitched a tent for his wife and afterwards one for himself (Genesis Rabbah 39:15).*

ויבן שם מזבח.

נִתְנַבֵּא שֶׁעֲתִידִין בָּנָיו לְהִכָּשֵׁל שָׁם עַל עֲוֹן עָכָן, וְהִתְפַּלֵּל שָׁם עֲלֵיהֶם:

ויבן שם מזבח *AND HE BUILDED THERE AN ALTAR — He perceived by the gift of prophecy that his descendants would once stumble (fall into sin) there through Achan's transgression (see, Joshua 7):*

therefore he prayed there for them (Genesis Rabbah 39:15).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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הלוך ונסוע.

לִפְרָקִים יוֹשֵׁב כָּאן חֹדֶשׁ אוֹ יוֹתֵר, וְנוֹסֵעַ מִשָּׁם וְנוֹטֶה אָהֳלוֹ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר, וְכָל מַסָּעָיו הַנֶּגְבָּה,

הלוך ונסוע *GOING ON MORE AND MORE TOWARDS THE NEGEB — by stages:*

לְלֶכֶת לִדְרוֹמָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְהִיא לְצַד יְרוּשָׁלַיִם, שֶׁהוּא בְּחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל יְהוּדָה,

he stayed here a month or more, then travelled on and pitched his tent in another place.

שֶׁנִּטְלוּ בְּדִרוֹמָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַר הַמּוֹרִיָּה שֶׁהִיא נַחֲלָתוֹ (בראשית רבה):

Yet all his journeys were towards the Negeb to proceed to the South of the land of Israel which is the direction where Jerusalem is — which is in the territory of Judah who had their portion in the South of the land of Israel — to Mount Moriah which is his (Judah's) possession (cf.

Genesis Rabbah 39:16).

רעב בארץ.

בְּאוֹתָהּ הָאָרֶץ לְבַדָּהּ, לְנַסּוֹתוֹ, אִם יְהַרְהֵר אַחַר דְּבָרָיו שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה שֶׁאָמַר לָלֶכֶת אֶל אֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן, וְעַכְשָׁו מַשִּׁיאוֹ לָצֵאת מִמֶּנָּה:

רעב בארץ *A FAMINE IN THE LAND — in that land only to test him whether he would take exception to God's commands in that He had bidden him to go to the land of Canaan and now forced him to leave it (Pirkei D'Rabbi Eliezer 26).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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הנה נא ידעתי.

מִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה עַד עַכְשָׁו לֹא הִכִּיר בָּהּ מִתּוֹךְ צְנִיעוּת שֶׁבִּשְׁנֵיהֶם, וְעַכְשָׁו הִכִּיר בָּהּ עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֶׂה. דָּבָר אַחֵר,

הנה נא ידעתי *BEHOLD NOW I KNOW — The Midrashic explanation is:*

מִנְהַג הָעוֹלָם שֶׁעַל יְדֵי טֹרַח הַדֶּרֶךְ אָדָם מִתְבַּזֶּה, וְזֹאת עָמְדָה בְּיָפְיָהּ.

Until now he had not perceived her beauty owing to the extreme modesty of both of them;

now, however, through this event, he became cognisant of it (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 5).

וּפְשׁוּטוֹ שֶׁל מִקְרָא הִנֵּה נָא הִגִּיעַ הַשָּׁעָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לִדְאֹג עַל יָפְיֵךְ,

Another explanation:

Usually, because of the exertion of travelling a person becomes uncomely, but she had retained her beauty (Genesis Rabbah 40:4).

יָדַעְתִּי זֶה יָמִים רַבִּים כִּי יְפַת מַרְאֶה אָתְּ,

Still, the real sense of the text is this:

וְעַכְשָׁו אָנוּ בָּאִים בֵּין אֲנָשִׁים שְׁחֹרִים וּמְכֹעָרִים, אֲחֵיהֶם שֶׁל כּוּשִׁים, וְלֹא הֻרְגְּלוּ בְּאִשָּׁה יָפָה;

Behold, now the time has come when I am anxious because of thy beauty.

I have long known that thou art fair of appearance:

וְדוֹמֶה לוֹ הִנֵּה נָא אֲדֹנַי סוּרוּ נָא (בר' י"ט):

but now we are travelling among black and repulsive people, brethren of the Ethiopians (Kushim), who have never been accustomed to see a beautiful woman.

A similar example is, (Genesis 19:2) "Behold, now, my lords, turn aside I pray you.").

למען ייטב לי בעבורך.

יִתְּנוּ לִי מַתָּנוֹת:

למען ייטב לי בעבורך *THAT IT MAY BE WELL WITH ME FOR THY SAKE — they may give me presents.*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three relationships

On לך לך (12:1) Rashi opens with pure peshat — 'for your own benefit, for your own good' — and then grafts two aggadot onto the gloss without marking the seam: 'there I will make of you a great nation, whilst here you will not merit the privilege of having children (Rosh Hashanah 16b); furthermore, I shall make known your character throughout the world (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 3).' The parenthetical attributions are his honesty

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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mechanism: the reader can see exactly which clause came from the study house and which from the verse. Compression with citations.

On אשר עשו בחרן (12:5) the order inverts, and that is the point. Rashi leads with the midrash — 'Abraham converted the men and Sarah converted the women, and Scripture accounts it unto them as if they had made them' (Bereshit Rabbah 39:14) — and only then rescues peshat: 'ופשוטו של מקרא, however, is slaves and maidservants they acquired, as in "he made all this wealth" (Gen 31:1).' The aggadah-first structure is deliberate: the conversion reading is too theologically load-bearing to relegate, but peshat gets the last word, explicitly labeled.

On הנה נא ידעתי (12:11) Rashi double-tracks openly: 'מדרש אגדה — until now he had not perceived her beauty owing to the extreme modesty of both of them; now, however, through this event, he became cognizant of it (Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 5). דבר אחר — usually, because of the exertion of travel a person becomes less attractive, but she retained her beauty.' The midrash is presented as midrash, the naturalistic reading as an alternative, and Rashi decides nothing. Two registers, side by side, both live.

Source excerpts via Sefaria's link data; Tanchuma excerpts were not returned by the API, so the relationships above are grounded in Rashi's comment text and his own attributions.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words from Genesis 12:1–13, each traced through the Historical Dictionary's citation corpus. A note on method: the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon (cal.huc.edu) prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow and BDB via Sefaria; the Hebrew journeys below come from Maagarim's own sweeps.

אַבְרָם

BDB · אברם

— n.pr.m. (id., Thes al. exalted father) Abram Gn 11:26, 27 + 57 times Gn (to 17:5) + 1 Ch 1:27 Ne 9:7; = אברהם Abraham Gn 17:5, 9, 15 + 172 times OT. (אברהם connected Gn 17:5 by word-play with הם of המון; really = אבר

BDB · אברם²

— v. אבירם, אבישי sub II. אבה.

Maagarim

אברם [שם פרטי] — 218 attestations, root none (proper name).

אברם — Abram. Maagarim's entry (אברם, proper name; 218 attestations, 9 citation pages) opens in the corpus exactly where the Torah opens him: Terah's genealogy (Gen 11:26–27), then the call itself — לך לך מארצך at 12:1 sits on page 1 of the citations, alongside Abram passing through the land at 12:6. After the biblical material the name nearly vanishes from the record until the Haskalah press revives it: Mendel Levin's חשבון הנפש (1844) holds

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Abram up as a moral exemplum, Sokolow's שנאת עולם לעם עולם (1882) invokes 'the family of Abram the Hebrew,' and the final citation is Mendele Mokher Sfarim's חיי שלמה (1910) — 'Abram sits in darkness.' A name that travels from genealogy to literature without ever detaching from Genesis: even in 1910, Abram is still the man of the call.

יְהוָֹה

Klein · יהוה

m.n.

— the proper name of God in the Bible, Tetragrammaton.

BDB · יהוה

— 6823 i.e. יהוה n.pr.dei Yahweh, the proper name of the God of Israel—(1. MT יהוה6518 (Qr אדני), or יהוה305 (Qr אלקים), in the combinations יהוה אדני & אדני יהוה (vid. אדני), and with prep. ביהוה, ל

BDB · יהוה²

— n.pr.dei, v. sub הוה p. 217 ff.

Maagarim

יהוה 1 (שם הוויה; הקרי המסורתי: אדני או אלקים) [שם פרטי] — 7387 attestations, root none (proper name).

יהוה — the Name. The sweep's scale is the story: 7,387 attestations across 312 citation pages, opening with the personal Name joined to the word for God in the primeval history (Gen 2:4–7). It is this Name that calls Abram in 12:1 and receives his altar and proclamation in 12:8. Then the arc bends into silence: after the Second Temple period the Name effectively disappears from Hebrew writing, and the corpus jumps two millennia to moderns who study rather than invoke it — Yaakov Rabinovitz on Tchernichovsky (1919) contrasting 'יהוה נביאי' with 'נביאי הבעל,' and Brenner's שכול וכישלון (1920) turning the Name over in introspection. The most-used word in the biblical corpus becomes the least-spoken — the Name everyone knows and no one pronounces.

אֶרֶץ

Klein · ארץ

f.n.

— land, country.

Jastrow · ארץ

f.

— רצץ; Ch. a. oth. dial. ארע fr. רעע to press together, stamp—from the rugged appearance of the surface after the subsidence of the waters) earth, dry land; country, land, field (opp. to town). Ex. R. s. 13 … threw dust up

BDB · ארץ

— n.f. Gn 10:11 & (seld.) m. Ez 21:24 earth, land (Ph. MI ארץ, Assyrian irṣitu COTGloss, Arabic , Sab. ארץ e.g. Os 9 DHMZMG 1875, 594, 614; Sem. Sprachf. 12, cf. PräBAS i. 374 n., Aramaic ארע,)—א׳ abs. Gn

Maagarim

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ארץ (form בארץ; no separate בארץ+ב entry — form-level query under erech3070) — 5,847 (form); 39,550 entry-wide attestations, root ארץ 1 (אדמה).

בארץ — in the land. The form-level sweep (5,847 occurrences under ארץ, root ארץ 'soil') opens with a wall of Dead Sea Scrolls: Jubilees' 'האמת בארץ,' the Prayer scroll's 'בארץ חמדות,' and the Damascus Document's signature phrase — ברית החדשה בארץ דמשק, 'the New Covenant in the land of Damascus' — where בארץ already means one specific territory, not earth at large. It closes with Bialik: 'כאן בארץ הזאת' against 'בגלות' — the Land of Israel as the opposite of exile (1933). Between Qumran and Bialik the form keeps its biblical breadth while repeatedly narrowing to the land par excellence. And in our aliyah — 'והכנעני אז בארץ' (12:6) — Abram walks into בארץ in exactly that specialized sense: not the earth, the Land he was called to enter.

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